

Lauren Pesce

Relocating to Washington, DC in September 2026 | pesceelauren@gmail.com | <https://lpesce57.github.io/Lauren-Pesce-Portfolio/>

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Multidisciplinary UI/UX designer with a background in UX research, front-end development, and product strategy. Experienced in designing intuitive, accessible digital experiences using Figma, creating scalable design systems, and collaborating with engineers to deliver user-centered solutions.

SKILLS

- **Programming & Frameworks:** Python, C++, JavaScript, Node.js, React.js, HTML, CSS, SQL, Django, REST APIs
- **Data Visualization:** Matplotlib, JSON, R
- **Design:** Figma, Canva, Adobe Photoshop/Lightroom, Wireframing, Prototyping, Information Architecture, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Visual Design, Accessibility, Responsive Design
- **Research:** UX Research, Interviews, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Heuristic Evaluations, Accessibility Audits, Affinity Mapping, Personas, Journey Mapping, Card Sorting, Contextual Inquiry
- **Dev Tools:** GitHub, Git Version Control, Xcode, Visual Studio, Google Analytics
- **Other:** API integration, Usability Metrics, Data-Driven Design, Debugging, System Testing, Test-Driven Development (TDD), Unit Testing, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Agile Development, Vite

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Chief Product Officer

Synth October 2025 – Present, Remote

- Led end-to-end product design and front-end execution for a consumer social platform, spanning UX, UI, accessibility, and implementation.
- Completed a comprehensive accessibility audit, identifying 30+ WCAG issues and delivering an accessible color system and design guide used to document a scalable design system in Figma, including typography, spacing, color tokens, and 50+ reusable components.
- Implemented front-end features and structural improvements using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, translating design systems into production-ready UI.
- Supported early-stage growth by shaping brand presence and leading social media strategy tied to product launches and engagement.

UX Design & Web Strategist

LakeMapper April 2026 – Present, Remote

- Designed and developed responsive website experiences using Shopify, Liquid, HTML, and CSS, translating business requirements into accessible, user-centered interfaces.
- Led UX and content improvements across customer-facing web experiences, including industry landing pages, help resources, blog content, and product education materials.
- Evaluated product workflows and usability issues, documenting actionable recommendations for navigation, search, account, and customer communication features.

User Experience Design Intern

Digital Summer Clinic June 2024 – August 2024, Ann Arbor, MI

- Executed user research through stakeholder interviews and analysis of historical company data to uncover core usability needs and define clear design priorities.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with marketing and company stakeholders to prototype and refine **Figma** wireframes and interaction designs, leading the redesign of 20% of the website and significantly improving overall usability and user experience.

NOTABLE PROJECTS

Maize and Blue Cupboard Website Redesign

University of Michigan • August 2024 – April 2025

- Conducted user research over the course of a year and identified core website issues through interviews, user testing, and accessibility audits, lowering task completion time by 58%.
- Created and tested a high-fidelity **Figma** prototype, incorporating UX design best practices and feedback from stakeholders to guide redesign recommendations, decreasing incorrect actions by 71% and delivering updated wireframes and information architecture to stakeholders for implementation.

Movie and Weather API Data Analysis

University of Michigan • November 2023 – December 2023

- Developed a data pipeline in **Python** that orchestrated queries across 4 APIs, integrating 400 movie data points and 100 weather records through **SQL** and **JSON**.
- Performed data integration and analysis to identify statistically significant correlations between movie popularity and Ann Arbor weather using **Matplotlib**.
- Collaborated in an Agile team environment, leveraging version control to manage real-time contributions, code reviews, and iterative development.

Responsive Harry Potter Game Website

University of Michigan • April 2025 – May 2025

- Engineered a responsive front-end website with interactive UI elements, creating 2 Harry Potter-themed games using **HTML**, **CSS**, and **JavaScript**.
- Applied gamification principles by incorporating timers, health bars, and scoreboards, enhancing user engagement and replay value.
- Integrated multiple public APIs and prioritized accessibility and UI polish to create an engaging user experience while meeting WCAG accessibility standards.

Piazza Machine Learning Post Classifier

University of Michigan • November 2023 – December 2023

- Developed a supervised learning classifier in **C++** to categorize Piazza posts using word frequency and labeled training data.
- Implemented feature extraction and preprocessing techniques including tokenization and case normalization to prepare raw input for classification.
- Conducted model evaluation to measure classification accuracy and refine performance.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

- **Summer Camp Counselor**, Camp Taum Sauk • Summers 2021-2025
- **Director of New Members**, Delta Gamma • November 2022 - December 2023
- **Director of Health & Wellness**, Delta Gamma • November 2022 - December 2023

EDUCATION

University of Michigan School of Information

Bachelor of Science in Information (BSI), User Experience (UX) Design

Minor in English • Ann Arbor, MI • Graduated May 2025

• **Cumulative GPA:** 3.76 / 4.00

- **Coursework:** Introduction to UX, Information Ethics, Data Oriented Programming, Web Design, Development and Accessibility, Programs and Data Structures, Introduction to Statistics, Needs Assessment and Usability, Building Data-Driven Web Applications, Building Interactive Applications, Interaction Design Studio, UX Driven Entrepreneurship, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- **Dean's List**, Multiple Semesters
- **Queen Mary University of London** Study Abroad, January 2024 - May 2024